

14

Surviving Black's Central Breaks

...c5, ...d5, and ...f6: recognize the purpose of each break and choose the correct form of tension.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will respond to central contact by evaluating lines and piece activity rather than trying to preserve the KIA diagram.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate White's candidates, find Black's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 079 | PAGE 4

Decode: Black's ...c5 expansion*Distinguish a space move from a forcing move; answer only what changes the position.*

LESSON 080 | PAGE 8

Play: Black's ...c5 expansion*Distinguish a space move from a forcing move; answer only what changes the position.*

LESSON 081 | PAGE 12

Decode: Black's freeing ...d5*A freeing break is judged by the pieces it releases, not by the pawn it trades.*

LESSON 082 | PAGE 16

Play: Black's freeing ...d5*A freeing break is judged by the pieces it releases, not by the pawn it trades.*

LESSON 083 | PAGE 20

Decode: Black's ...f6 strike*Against ...f6, preserve the attack, not necessarily the pawn.*

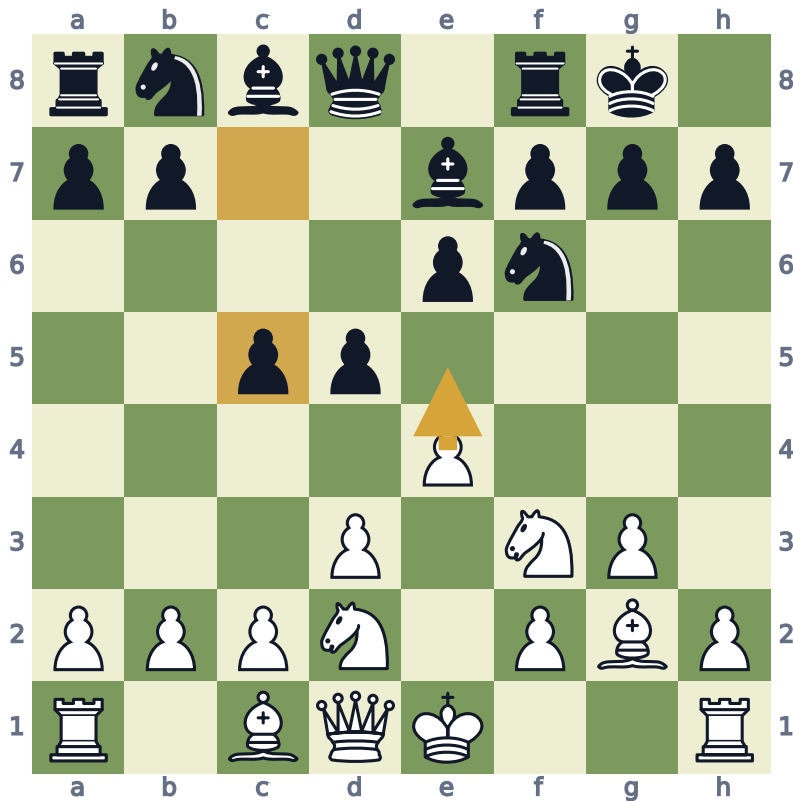
LESSON 084 | PAGE 24

Play: Black's ...f6 strike*Against ...f6, preserve the attack, not necessarily the pawn.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will respond to central contact by evaluating lines and piece activity rather than trying to preserve the KIA diagram.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Black's ...c5 expansion



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...c5 attacks d4, creates queenside space, and supports ...b5; it does not directly attack e5 but accelerates the wing race.

DECISION RULE

Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black gains space with ...b5-b4 and creates pressure on d3 while White's pieces move toward the kingside.

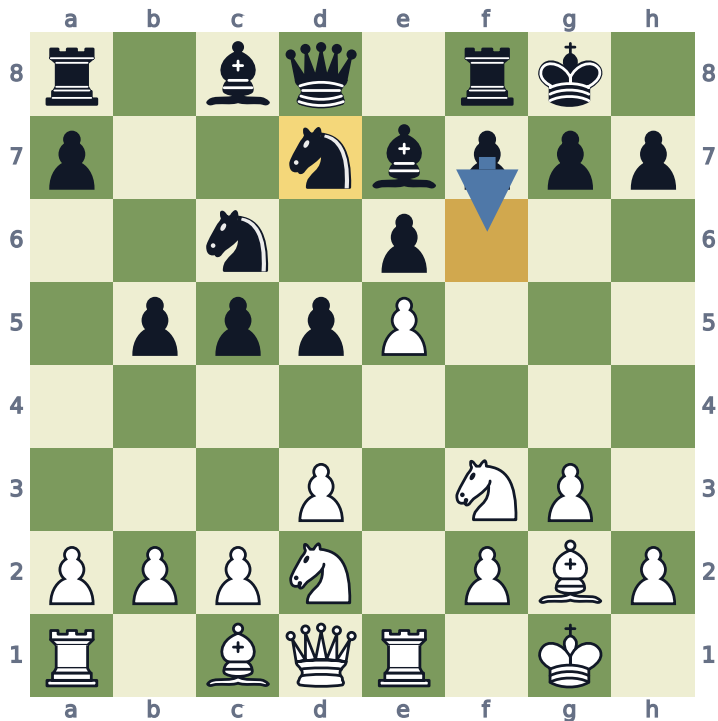
WHITE'S PLAN

White ignores harmless space, restrains real breakthroughs, and accelerates the kingside operation when Black spends non-forcing tempi.

MEMORY RULE | Distinguish a space move from a forcing move; answer only what changes the position.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...c5 attacks d4, creates queenside space, and supports ...b5; it does not directly attack e5 but accelerates the wing race.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black gains space with ...b5-b4 and creates pressure on d3 while White's pieces move toward the kingside.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White ignores harmless space, restrains real breakthroughs, and accelerates the kingside operation when Black spends non-forcing tempi.

FAILURE MODE

Reacting to space itself and losing the race by answering moves that threaten nothing.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

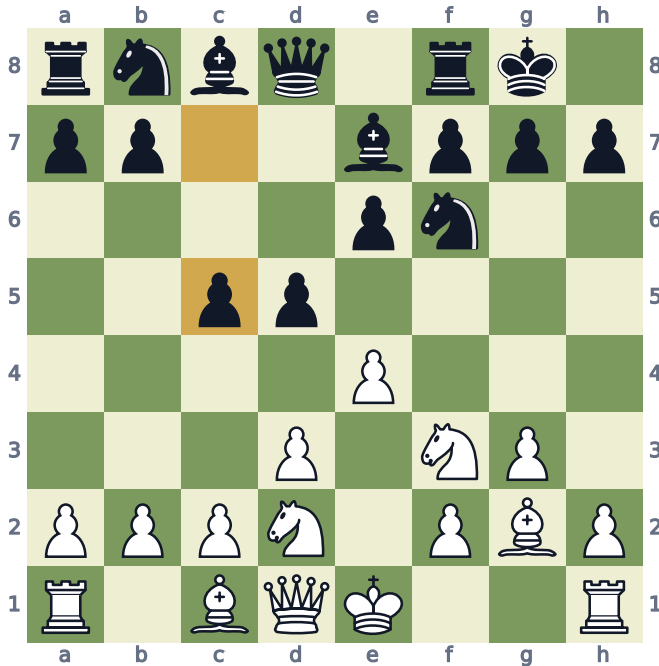
RULE | Distinguish a space move from a forcing move; answer only what changes the position.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7



- Ngf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- g3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...c5 attacks d4, creates queenside space, and supports ...b5; it does not directly attack e5 but accelerates the wing race.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack? White's attacking or positional plan is: White ignores harmless space, restrains real breakthroughs, and accelerates the kingside operation when Black spends non-forcing tempi. The line fails as a template when: Reacting to space itself and losing the race by answering moves that threaten nothing.

STORE THIS | Distinguish a space move from a forcing move; answer only what changes the position.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

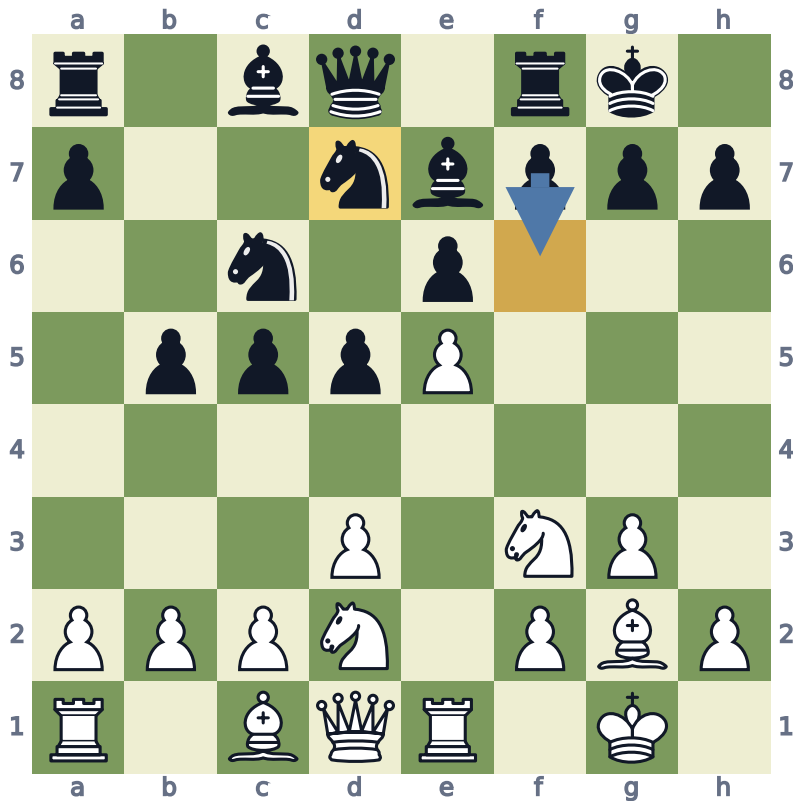
1. ...c5 attacks d4, creates queenside space, and supports ...b5; it does not directly attack e5 but accelerates the wing race. 2. Black gains space with ...b5-b4 and creates pressure on d3 while White's pieces move toward the kingside. 3. White ignores harmless space, restrains real breakthroughs, and accelerates the kingside operation when Black spends non-forcing tempi. 4. Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack? 5. Reacting to space itself and losing the race by answering moves that threaten nothing.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Black's ...c5 expansion



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...c5 attacks d4, creates queenside space, and supports ...b5; it does not directly attack e5 but accelerates the wing race.

DECISION RULE

Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black gains space with ...b5-b4 and creates pressure on d3 while White's pieces move toward the kingside.

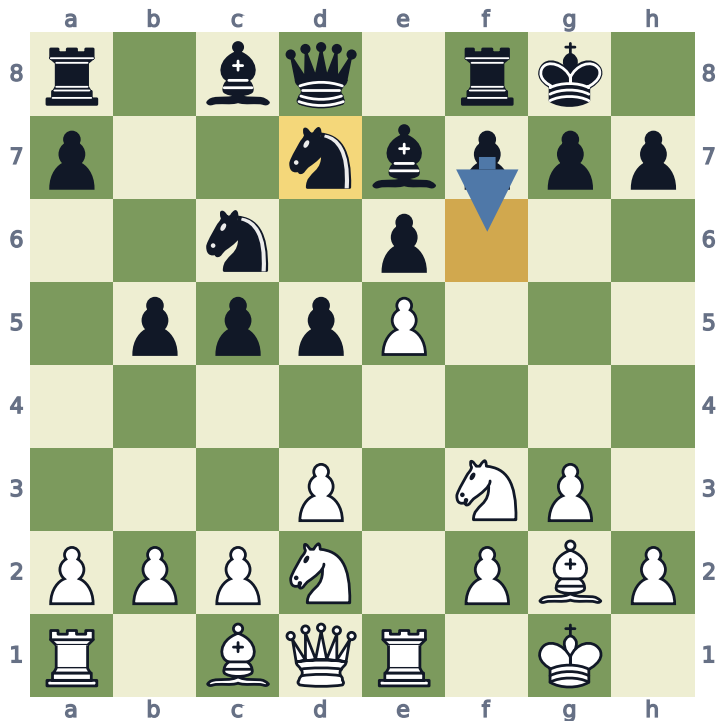
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White ignores harmless space, restrains real breakthroughs, and accelerates the kingside operation when Black spends non-forcing tempi.

MEMORY RULE | Distinguish a space move from a forcing move; answer only what changes the position.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

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BLACK AIMS FOR

Black gains space with ...b5-b4 and creates pressure on d3 while White's pieces move toward the kingside.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White ignores harmless space, restrains real breakthroughs, and accelerates the kingside operation when Black spends non-forcing tempi.

FAILURE MODE

Reacting to space itself and losing the race by answering moves that threaten nothing.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

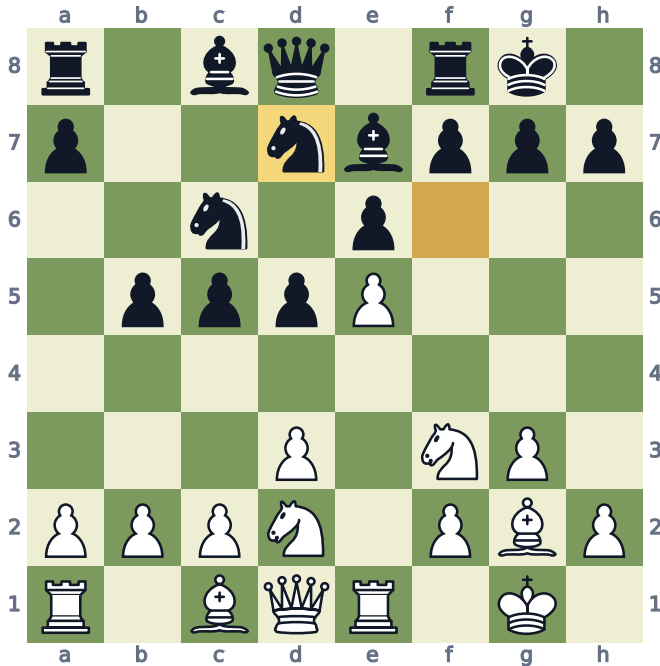
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...c5 attacks d4, creates queenside space, and supports ...b5; it does not directly attack e5 but accelerates the wing race.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack? White's attacking or positional plan is: White ignores harmless space, restrains real breakthroughs, and accelerates the kingside operation when Black spends non-forcing tempi. The line fails as a template when: Reacting to space itself and losing the race by answering moves that threaten nothing.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

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4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

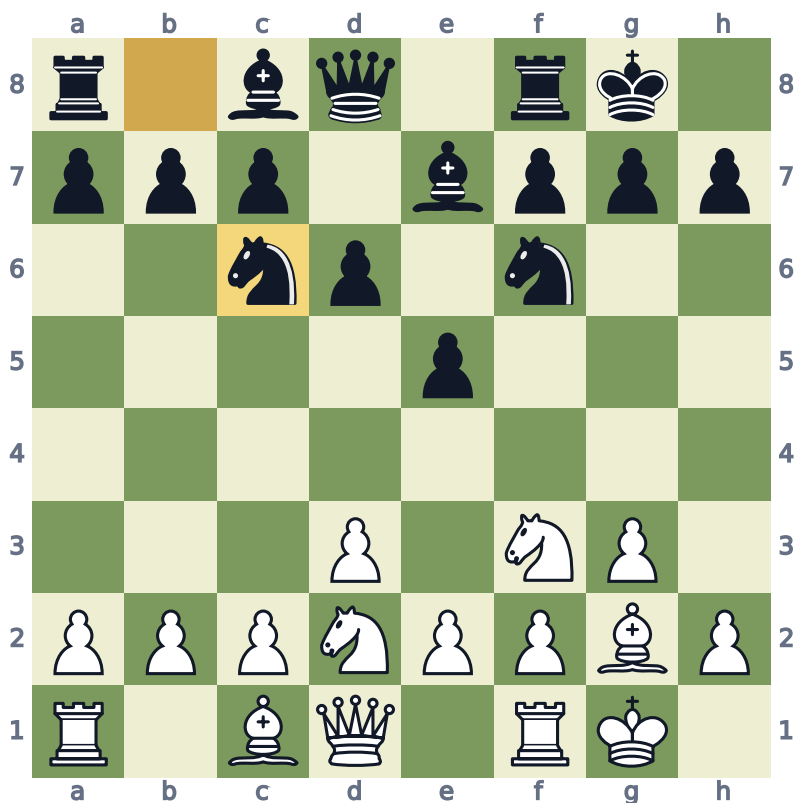
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Black's freeing ...d5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

In symmetrical ...e5 structures, ...d5 frees Black's pieces and challenges White's center; allowing it under ideal conditions can erase the opening advantage.

DECISION RULE

After ...d5, which recapture opens a file for whose rook, and which central pawn becomes isolated?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black prepares the break with pieces and chooses exchanges that activate bishops and rooks.

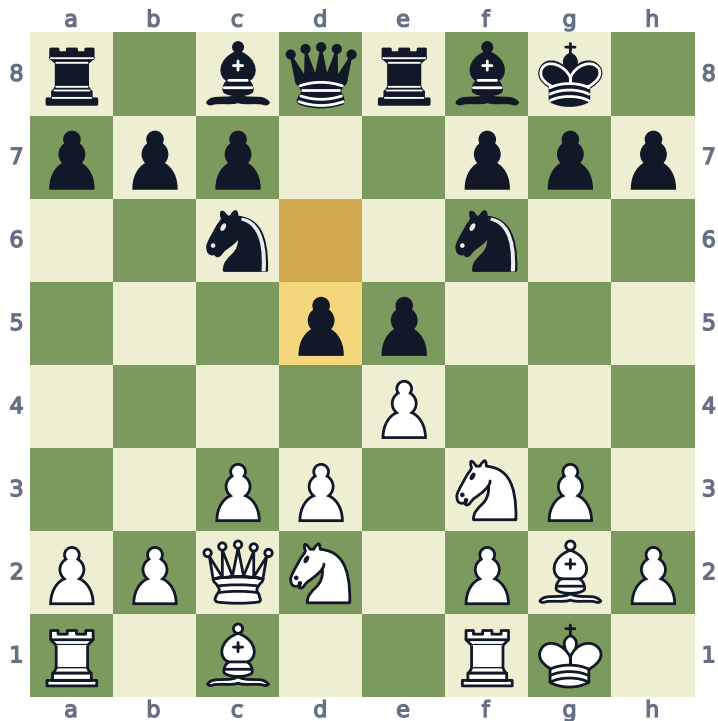
WHITE'S PLAN

White restrains ...d5, captures only when the open files favor White, or plays d4 first to control the transformation.

MEMORY RULE | A freeing break is judged by the pieces it releases, not by the pawn it trades.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

In symmetrical ...e5 structures, ...d5 frees Black's pieces and challenges White's center; allowing it under ideal conditions can erase the opening advantage.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black prepares the break with pieces and chooses exchanges that activate bishops and rooks.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White restrains ...d5, captures only when the open files favor White, or plays d4 first to control the transformation.

FAILURE MODE

Treating every central exchange as simplification without comparing the resulting piece activity.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After ...d5, which recapture opens a file for whose rook, and which central pawn becomes isolated? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

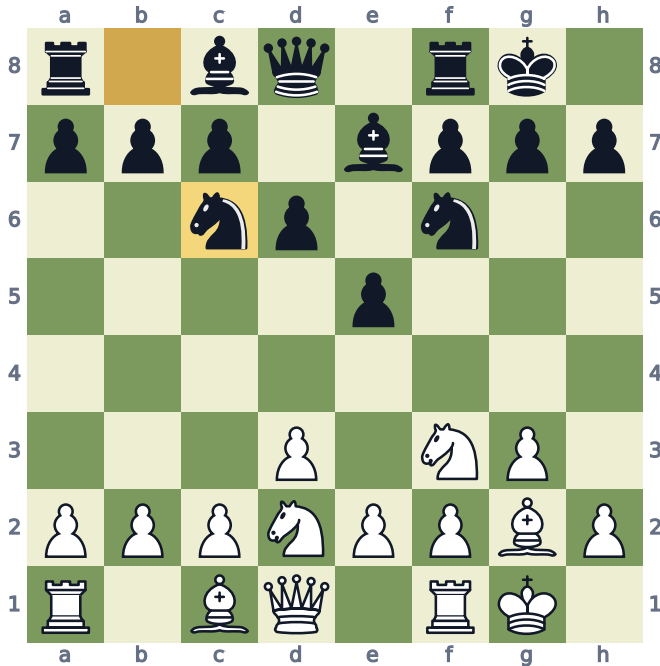
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Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d6 2. g3 e5 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 Nc6 7. e4 Re8 8. c3 Bf8 9. Qc2 d5



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- d3: White supports e4 and keeps the center compact at the cost of space on d4.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

In symmetrical ...e5 structures, ...d5 frees Black's pieces and challenges White's center; allowing it under ideal conditions can erase the opening advantage.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After ...d5, which recapture opens a file for whose rook, and which central pawn becomes isolated? White's attacking or positional plan is: White restrains ...d5, captures only when the open files favor White, or plays d4 first to control the transformation. The line fails as a template when: Treating every central exchange as simplification without comparing the resulting piece activity.

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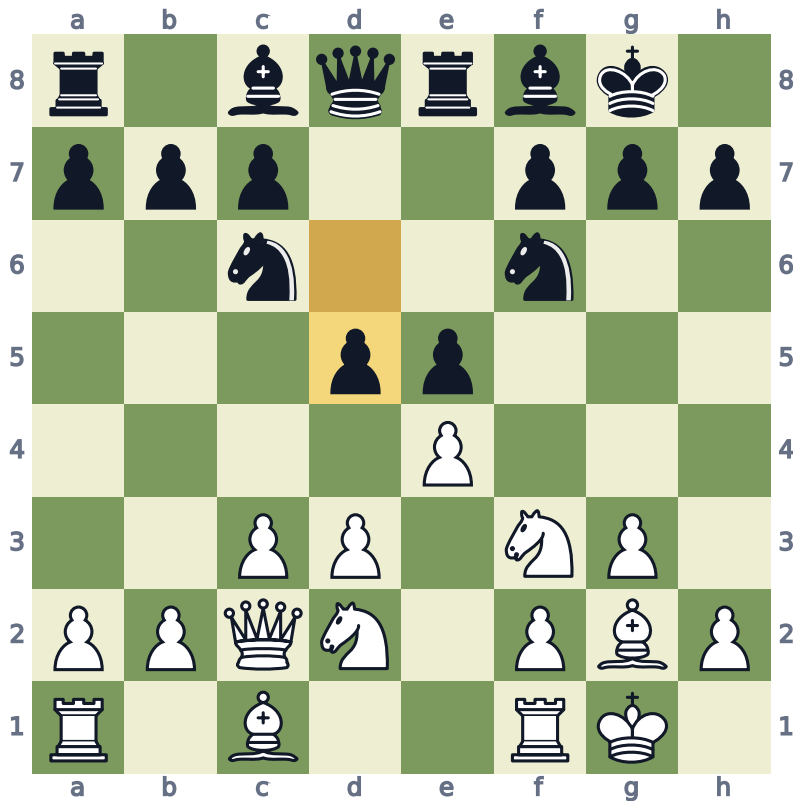
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SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

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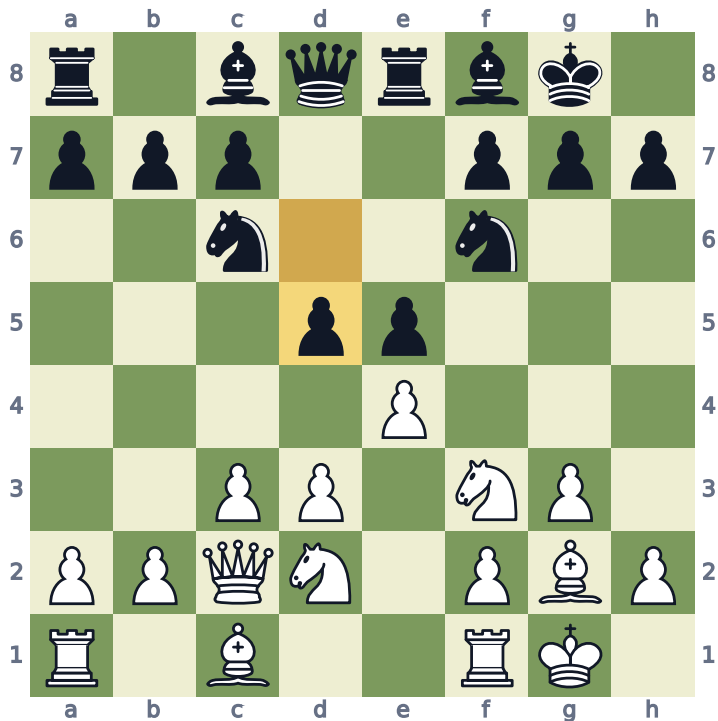
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

In symmetrical ...e5 structures, ...d5 frees Black's pieces and challenges White's center; allowing it under ideal conditions can erase the opening advantage.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black prepares the break with pieces and chooses exchanges that activate bishops and rooks.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White restrains ...d5, captures only when the open files favor White, or plays d4 first to control the transformation.

FAILURE MODE

Treating every central exchange as simplification without comparing the resulting piece activity.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After ...d5, which recapture opens a file for whose rook, and which central pawn becomes isolated? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

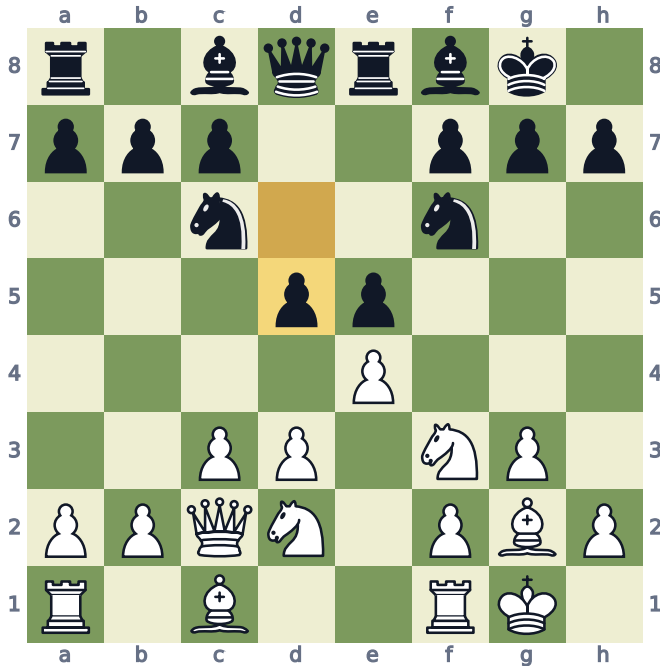
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d6 2. g3 e5 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 Nc6 7. e4 Re8 8. c3 Bf8 9. Qc2 d5



- e4: White builds the KIA center but must account for Black's immediate central break.
- Re8: Black places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- c3: White restrains d4 and prepares a central d4 break.
- Bf8: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- Qc2: White coordinates center and wing plans, but must check whether the queen becomes a tempo target.
- d5: Black claims central space and challenges White to justify the restrained d3 setup.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

In symmetrical ...e5 structures, ...d5 frees Black's pieces and challenges White's center; allowing it under ideal conditions can erase the opening advantage.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After ...d5, which recapture opens a file for whose rook, and which central pawn becomes isolated? White's attacking or positional plan is: White restrains ...d5, captures only when the open files favor White, or plays d4 first to control the transformation. The line fails as a template when: Treating every central exchange as simplification without comparing the resulting piece activity.

STORE THIS | A freeing break is judged by the pieces it releases, not by the pawn it trades.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

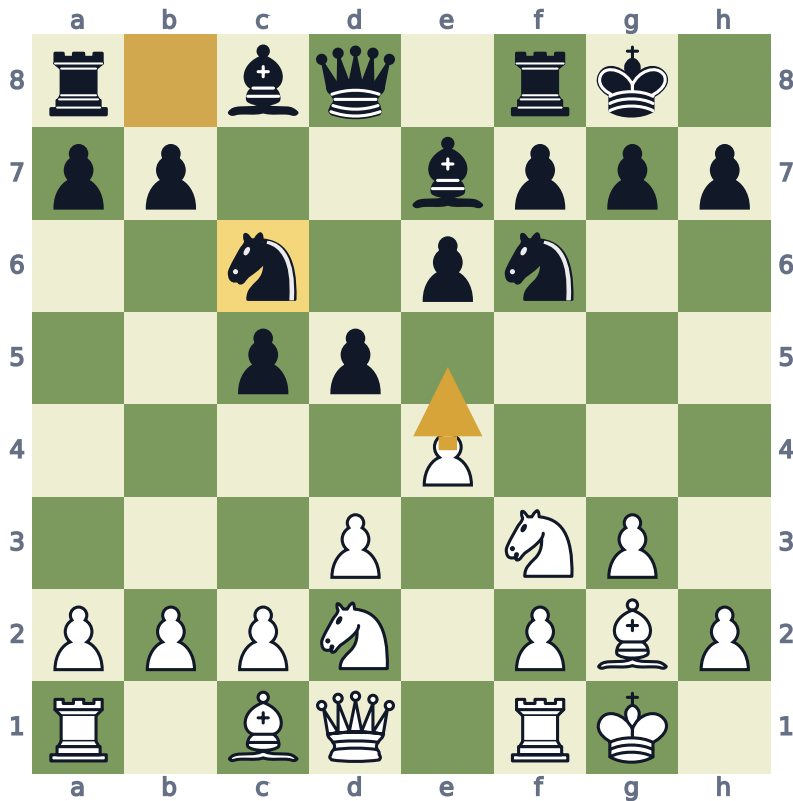
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. e4 Re8 8. c3 Bf8 9. Qc2 d5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Black's ...f6 strike



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...f6 directly challenges the e5 wedge and can open the f-file toward both kings, turning a strategic attack into concrete calculation.

DECISION RULE

Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black times the break when the king has enough defenders and the recapture develops a piece or gains central control.

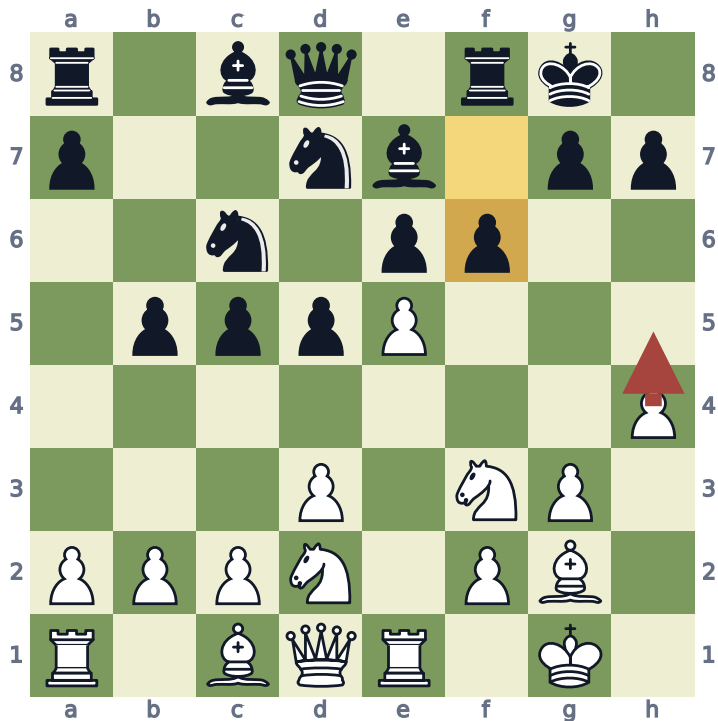
WHITE'S PLAN

White evaluates exf6, e6, or support of e5 by checking every opened diagonal and the e-file battery.

MEMORY RULE | Against ...f6, preserve the attack, not necessarily the pawn.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...f6 directly challenges the e5 wedge and can open the f-file toward both kings, turning a strategic attack into concrete calculation.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black times the break when the king has enough defenders and the recapture develops a piece or gains central control.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White evaluates exf6, e6, or support of e5 by checking every opened diagonal and the e-file battery.

FAILURE MODE

Protecting the e5 pawn reflexively and missing a stronger line-opening sacrifice.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

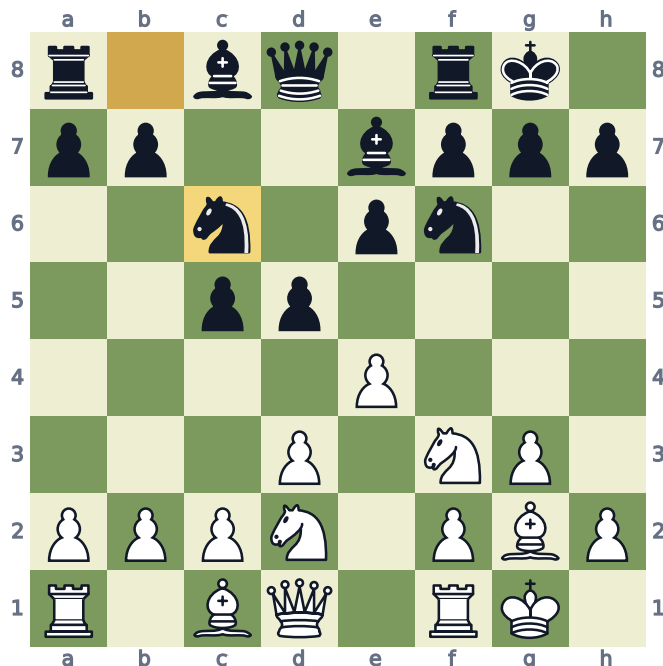
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 f6



- g3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
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WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...f6 directly challenges the e5 wedge and can open the f-file toward both kings, turning a strategic attack into concrete calculation.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange? White's attacking or positional plan is: White evaluates exf6, e6, or support of e5 by checking every opened diagonal and the e-file battery. The line fails as a template when: Protecting the e5 pawn reflexively and missing a stronger line-opening sacrifice.

STORE THIS | Against ...f6, preserve the attack, not necessarily the pawn.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

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ANSWER KEY

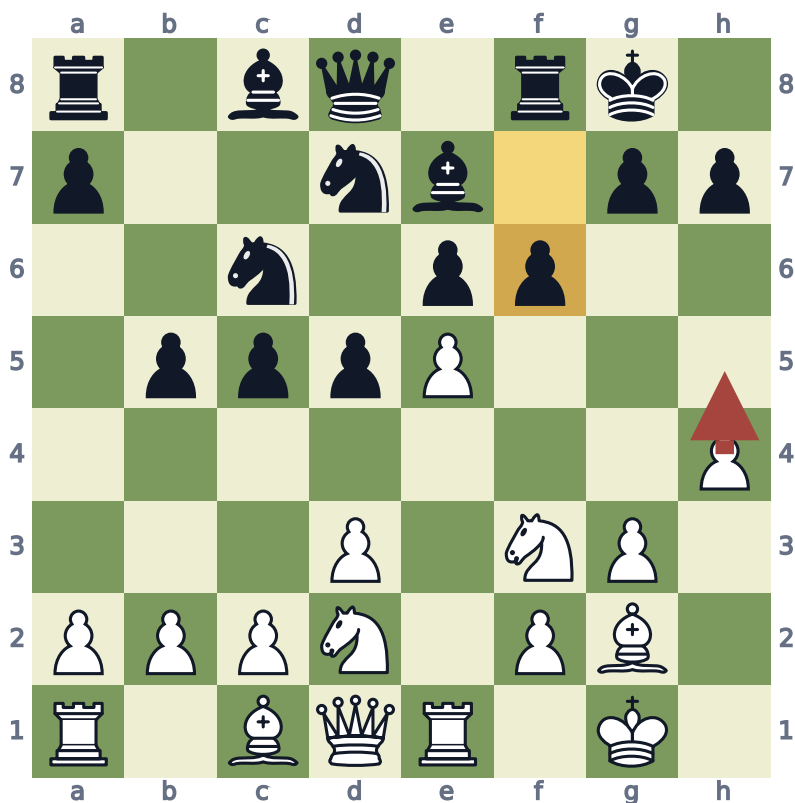
1. ...f6 directly challenges the e5 wedge and can open the f-file toward both kings, turning a strategic attack into concrete calculation. 2. Black times the break when the king has enough defenders and the recapture develops a piece or gains central control. 3. White evaluates exf6, e6, or support of e5 by checking every opened diagonal and the e-file battery. 4. Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange? 5. Protecting the e5 pawn reflexively and missing a stronger line-opening sacrifice.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Black's ...f6 strike



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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DECISION RULE

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SIDE TO MOVE

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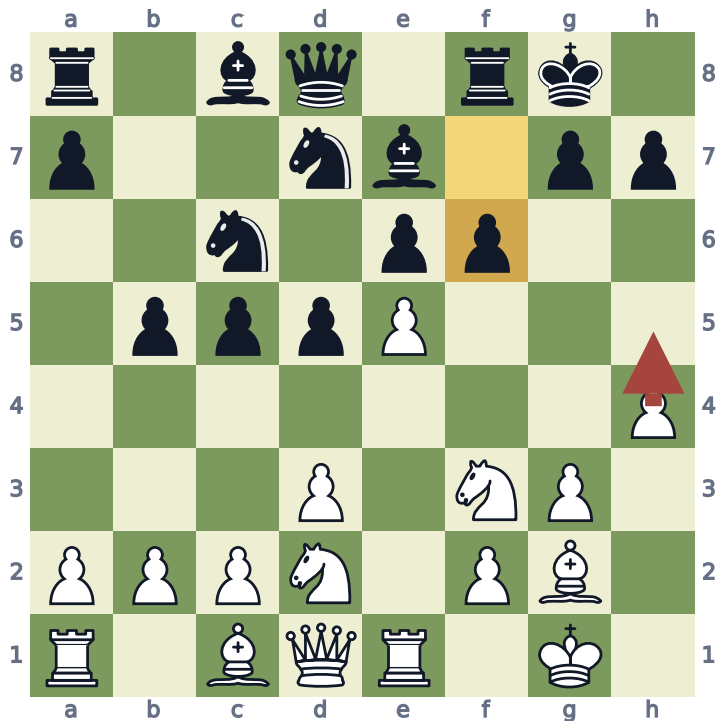
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

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BLACK AIMS FOR

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White evaluates exf6, e6, or support of e5 by checking every opened diagonal and the e-file battery.

FAILURE MODE

Protecting the e5 pawn reflexively and missing a stronger line-opening sacrifice.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

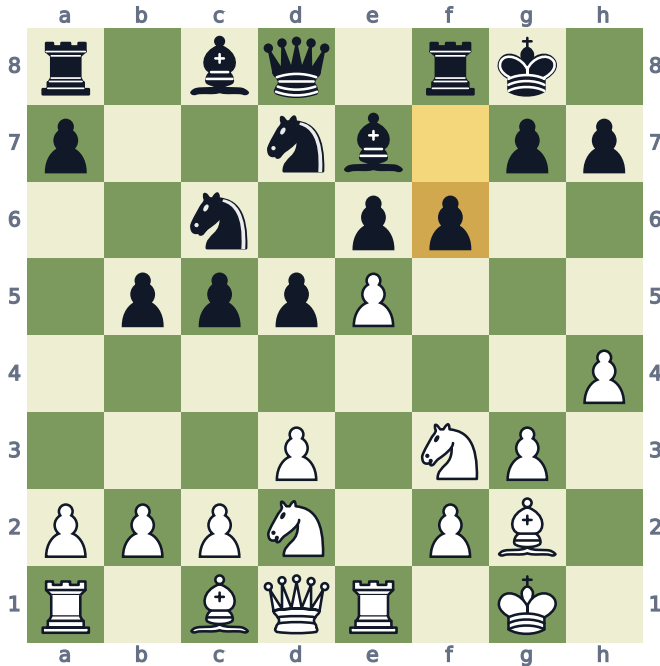
RULE | Against ...f6, preserve the attack, not necessarily the pawn.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 f6



- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- f6: Black strikes at the head of White's e5 pawn chain and opens tactical lines.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...f6 directly challenges the e5 wedge and can open the f-file toward both kings, turning a strategic attack into concrete calculation.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange? White's attacking or positional plan is: White evaluates exf6, e6, or support of e5 by checking every opened diagonal and the e-file battery. The line fails as a template when: Protecting the e5 pawn reflexively and missing a stronger line-opening sacrifice.

STORE THIS | Against ...f6, preserve the attack, not necessarily the pawn.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. ...f6 directly challenges the e5 wedge and can open the f-file toward both kings, turning a strategic attack into concrete calculation. 2. Black times the break when the king has enough defenders and the recapture develops a piece or gains central control. 3. White evaluates exf6, e6, or support of e5 by checking every opened diagonal and the e-file battery. 4. Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange? 5. Protecting the e5 pawn reflexively and missing a stronger line-opening sacrifice.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 f6

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 079 Decode: Black's ...c5 expansion

Prompt: Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack?

Recall: Distinguish a space move from a forcing move; answer only what changes the position.

LESSON 080 Play: Black's ...c5 expansion

Prompt: Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack?

Recall: Distinguish a space move from a forcing move; answer only what changes the position.

LESSON 081 Decode: Black's freeing ...d5

Prompt: After ...d5, which recapture opens a file for whose rook, and which central pawn becomes isolated?

Recall: A freeing break is judged by the pieces it releases, not by the pawn it trades.

LESSON 082 Play: Black's freeing ...d5

Prompt: After ...d5, which recapture opens a file for whose rook, and which central pawn becomes isolated?

Recall: A freeing break is judged by the pieces it releases, not by the pawn it trades.

LESSON 083 Decode: Black's ...f6 strike

Prompt: Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange?

Recall: Against ...f6, preserve the attack, not necessarily the pawn.

LESSON 084 Play: Black's ...f6 strike

Prompt: Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange?

Recall: Against ...f6, preserve the attack, not necessarily the pawn.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's counterplay, White's plan, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Black's ...c5 expansion

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

Decision: Does ...c5 create an immediate threat, or does it give White one more move for the attack?

Memory: Distinguish a space move from a forcing move; answer only what changes the position.

CARD 2

Black's freeing ...d5

1. Nf3 d6 2. g3 e5 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 Nc6 7. e4 Re8 8. c3 Bf8 9. Qc2 d5

Decision: After ...d5, which recapture opens a file for whose rook, and which central pawn becomes isolated?

Memory: A freeing break is judged by the pieces it releases, not by the pawn it trades.

CARD 3

Black's ...f6 strike

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 f6

Decision: Which side benefits from the f-file and e-file after each possible pawn exchange?

Memory: Against ...f6, preserve the attack, not necessarily the pawn.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
079 Decode: Black's ...c5 expansion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
080 Play: Black's ...c5 expansion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
081 Decode: Black's freeing ...d5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
082 Play: Black's freeing ...d5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
083 Decode: Black's ...f6 strike	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
084 Play: Black's ...f6 strike	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name Black's strongest counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.